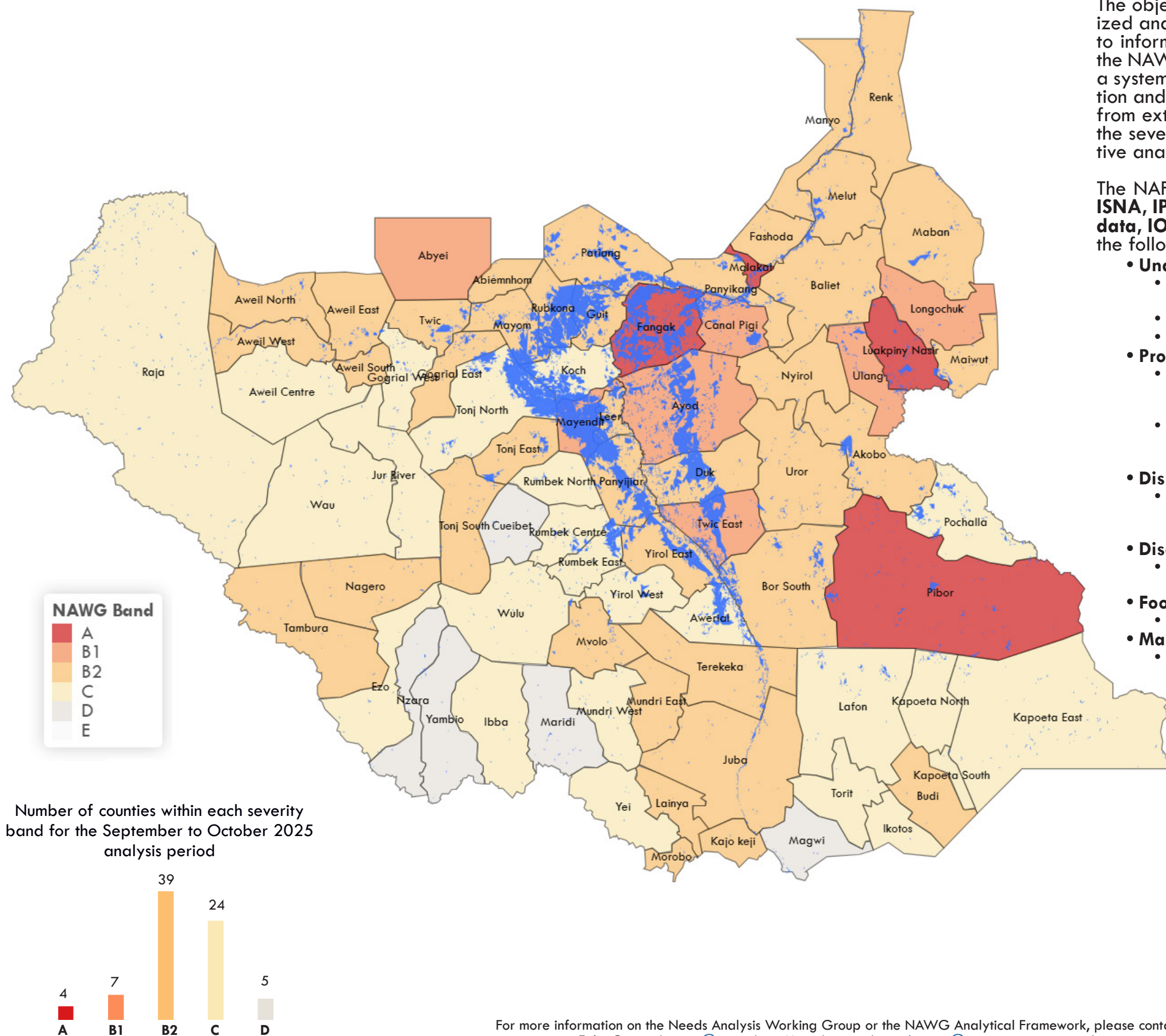


SOUTH SUDAN - NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

September - October 2025 Analysis



Background

The NAWG meeting was held on November 11th, 2025 to discuss the analysis of the **September to October** period.

The objective of the NAWG is to conduct evidence-based and contextualized analysis of critical life-saving humanitarian needs across South Sudan to inform decision-making and prioritization by the ICCG. To enable this, the NAWG analytical framework (NAF) was developed. The NAF provides a systematic approach to interpret a wide array of multi-sectoral information and monitor needs at the county-level. The final classification (ranging from extreme to minor humanitarian needs) is an intersectoral measure of the severity of humanitarian conditions in a county, allowing for comparative analysis between counties and across time.

The NAF encompasses data from a variety of sources (including **FSNMS, ISNA, IPC AFI and AMN, SMART surveys, JMMI, ACLED, IRNAs, REACH data, IOM DTM, WHO IDSR, PRMS, and data from clusters**) which inform the following indicators:

- **Underlying vulnerability**
 - Proportion of female-headed households, child-headed households and other vulnerable-group headed households
 - Proportion of IDPs and/or returnees compared to host communities
 - Longitudinal food insecurity
- **Protection**
 - Reports of explosive hazards, lack of access to humanitarian assistance, restriction of movement, sexual violence, family separation, HLP issues, child labour, civil documentation issues, among others
 - Armed conflict events and/or conflict-related sexual violence and/or forced recruitment of children and/or targeted killings of civilians and/or targeted property destruction
- **Displacement**
 - Number of displaced persons arriving and/or number of returnees returning, as significant numbers of arrivals has the potential to exacerbate food and resource access
- **Disease**
 - Disease outbreaks, including cholera, measles, meningitis, and malaria, among others
- **Food insecurity**
 - IPC AFI classifications are used for each county
- **Malnutrition**
 - IPC AMN classifications or SMART survey data are used as a proxy for life-threatening acute malnutrition and excess mortality risk.

Needs severity levels

Severity band	Indicator threshold	Severity level definitions
A	8 - 10	Extreme humanitarian conditions
B1	7 - 7.9	Severe humanitarian conditions (higher severity)
B2	6 - 6.9	Severe humanitarian conditions (lower severity)
C	4 - 5.9	Moderate humanitarian conditions
D	2 - 3.9	Stressed humanitarian conditions
E	0 - 1.9	Minor or acceptable humanitarian conditions

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Note on Seasonal Trends in Needs Severity

The September-October analysis reflects a notable, though largely seasonal, decrease in the overall severity of needs compared to the June-July lean season period. This is primarily driven by the transition to the post-harvest period, which is captured in the latest IPC classifications.

The number of counties classified in Band B1 (Severe) fell from 24 to 7 in the quantitative (pre-contextual) analysis. Of the 19 counties that moved out of B1, the main driver was an improvement in food security, with 16 counties seeing their IPC AFI classification improve from Phase 4 to Phase 3. A secondary driver was a relative easing of protection risks identified during the period. Three counties previously in Band A (Ayod, Abyei, Ulang) moved down to Band B1, reflecting this general improvement.

Counties Facing “Extreme” Humanitarian Conditions

Four counties were classified as exhibiting extreme humanitarian needs (Band A) in this analysis period. **Fangak** and **Nasir** were automatically classified as **Band A** due to having pockets of the population experiencing IPC Phase 5 (Catastrophe) conditions.

Pibor and **Malakal** were also classified as **Band A** due to the compounding impact of high protection risks, significant displacement, and severe disease burdens.

Discussion and Joint Analysis

- **Mayendit:** Flagged due to a persistent and severe cholera outbreak, reporting the highest number of new cases nationwide (36% of all cases) in the last two weeks of October. The situation is exacerbated by the significant and prolonged impact of flooding in the county. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B1.**
- **Longochuk:** Flagged due to severe and persistent humanitarian access constraints, with reports of humanitarian actors being denied movement. This has limited civilian access to basic services and necessitated food assistance delivery via airdrops. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B1, added to close monitoring.**
- **Canal/Pigi:** Flagged due to a significant escalation of conflict, including airstrikes in August and an intensification of hostilities with armed clashes and artillery strikes through September and late October. An estimated 18,000 people have also been displaced by floods. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B1, added to close monitoring.**
- **Mundri East:** Flagged due to armed clashes in September and October, including an offensive by opposition forces and attacks on public infrastructure like markets and health facilities. An estimated 30,000 people were

reportedly displaced. **Final classification: Elevated from C to B2.**

- **Nagero:** Flagged due to a significantly deteriorating security situation throughout September and October, including reported attacks on key transport routes, the destruction of a bridge isolating the county from Tambura, and airstrikes on October 15th. Access is severely constrained. **Final classification: Elevated from C to B2.**
- **Tambura:** Flagged for reasons similar to Nagero, having faced a comparable escalation of conflict in mid-October with airstrikes that have contributed to instability and displacement. **Elevated from Band C to Band B2.**
- **Wau:** Flagged as it has become a primary destination for a significant influx of displaced populations fleeing the conflict in Nagero and Tambura, placing a strain on local services and resources. An emergency assessment is being planned. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C, added to close monitoring.**
- **Ezo:** Flagged due to the humanitarian impact of conflict in neighboring counties, with an estimated 52,000 people displaced from Tambura into Ezo in late September. This has reportedly disrupted local crop production, trade, and market functionality. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C, added to close monitoring.**
- **Morobo:** Flagged due to a series of retaliatory conflict incidents throughout October, including an opposition overrun of a government barracks followed by government shelling of opposition positions. **Final classification: Elevated from C to B2.**
- **Jur River:** Flagged due to an escalation of conflict, its role as a destination for displaced people from Tambura and Nagero, and internal displacement caused by aerial bombardments in October. **Final classification: Elevated from D to C, added to close monitoring.**

Counties Flagged for Close Monitoring

The following counties have been flagged for close monitoring to encourage partners to gather more information and closely track the evolving situation. Partners are requested to pay close attention to these counties and share any relevant information.

- **Fangak (Band A):** Close monitoring is required as the county is classified as IPC AFI Phase 4 with a pocket of 5% of the population in Phase 5. This severe food insecurity is exacerbated by compromised humanitarian access, highlighted by multiple incidents in September where aid boats and storage facilities were looted, resulting in the diversion of essential supplies.
- **Nasir (Band A):** Close monitoring is required due to a recent escalation of conflict in its southern payams (Mandeng, Jikmir, Kurenge, and Burebiey), which has

further restricted already limited humanitarian access. This instability compounds the county's severe food insecurity, which is classified as IPC AFI Phase 4 with a pocket of 5% of the population in Phase 5 in the current period.

- **Ayod (Band B1):** Close monitoring is required due to the significant humanitarian impact of flooding. As of OCHA's September Floods Snapshot, an estimated 44,000 people have been displaced by floods.
- **Ulang (Band B1):** Close monitoring is required due to the county's high underlying vulnerability, particularly after being identified as being at risk of Famine earlier in the year. Although violence has reportedly reduced and humanitarian access has recently improved, the situation remains extremely fragile.
- **Twic East (Band B1):** Close monitoring is required due to the severe impact of flooding with reports of 24,000 people displaced by floods in September.
- **Longochuk (Band B1):** Close monitoring is required due to severe and persistent humanitarian access constraints. These challenges have necessitated the use of food airdrops and continue to limit the ability of partners to comprehensively assess and respond to needs on the ground.
- **Canal/Pigi (Band B1):** Close monitoring is required following a significant escalation of conflict through September and October. This violence is compounded by the pre-existing displacement of an estimated 18,000 people by floods.
- **Baliet (Band B2):** Close monitoring is warranted as the county is projected to face IPC Acute Malnutrition (AMN) Phase 5 (Extremely Critical) conditions in the upcoming season.
- **Panyijiar (Band B2):** Close monitoring is required due to extensive flooding, with OCHA reporting that an estimated 37,000 people have been displaced by floodwaters.
- **Mvolo (Band B2):** Close monitoring required due to the humanitarian impact of flooding, which displaced an estimated 14,000 people. Partners are particularly concerned about the anticipated increase in public health risks, including outbreaks of waterborne diseases and a rise in malaria cases, which are expected as the floodwaters recede.
- **Wau, Ezo, and Jur River (Band C):** These counties require close monitoring due to the significant humanitarian impact of conflict in Western Equatoria. Wau and Jur River have received a large influx of IDPs fleeing violence in Nagero and Tambura (over 9,000 reported in Wau), while Ezo has received an estimated 52,000 displaced people. This large-scale displacement is straining local services and resources, disrupting markets and agricultural production, and creating new needs in host communities.